

Thread - 2026-01-20

<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/2013621864271081926>

1/1 - 2026-01-20 14:37 UTC

So given the odd radius display on my car window on 18/19 January 2026, how common is odd radii on glass surfaces in general? I know only one earlier observation: in Kuopio, Finland, Juhana Hakumäki reported of a display of 9 and 22° halos in his school classroom large window on 3 December 1986. Moreover, he mentioned the 22° halo consisting of two successive spectra, so 24° halo was there as well. In November of the same year he had seen with Timo Nousiainen 22° halo in the same window.

This must have been some special window. I rarely see frosted windows in warm buildings in the first place, and if I do see them, it's fern frost – no halos. And even if halo crystals would form, they should be oriented – no circular halos. Circular halos have been visible on my car windows many times, but those are from heavy diamond dust precipitation events that quickly dump a layer on the inclined glass surfaces, the windscreen and rear windows. I wonder how long it's gonna be until we have a repeat observation of the Kuopio window pane displays.

The observations appear in Ursa Minor circular 1/1987 Sivuaurinko section, written by Marko Pekkola. The two images here are an English facsimile translation, done under my oversight by Grok. The original: <https://t.co/lcf2Pyba5X>

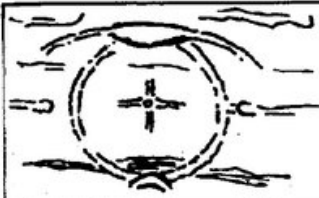
	Date	Locality	Observers	First ice fog dates
1.	4.12.	Kuopio	Nousiainen, Hakumäki	for various
2.	6/7.12.	Kemi	Markku Ruonala	localities. The
3.	12.12.	Mikkeli	Petri Tuovinen	table is somewhat
4.	15.12.	Hamina	Hannu Heiskanen	incomplete, as not
5.	16.12.	Illo	Teemu Hankamäki	all end-of-year
6.	18.12.	Liminka	Ismo Luukkonen	observations have
6.	18.12.	Imatra	Veikko Mäkelä	arrived yet.
7.	18.12.	Helsinki	Many observers	

DECEMBER ICE FOG HALOS

The first proper ice fog halos were visible in several localities around December 15. On the night of December 15/16, Hakumäki, Heikkinen and Nousiainen captured a submoon in Kuopio. In the photos this phenomenon looked like a very clearly defined vertical (mostly an American football resembling) object consisting of separate ice crystals floating against this or that snowbank. The night's ice fog outburst was so strong that reportedly even artificial lights had their own "sub-artificial lights". On the same night, also in Kuopio, Mika Koistinen saw Lowitz arcs by the Moon (!), as well as a 22° ring birthed by a street lamp. Lowitz arcs are often so faint and vague even in sunlight that I am not at all surprised that they have not been seen before in Finland as formed by the Moon.

A couple of nights after the submoon, Timo Nousiainen also observed a Venus pillar ($1/4^\circ + 1/4^\circ$). No other Venus halo observations have yet appeared in the end-of-year forms. Also only 1 subsun observation from the end of '86 so far – namely, the one that Teemu Hankamäki saw on Christmas Eve in Illo. The Illo subsun was 5° long and colored RO. While writing this article (at my parents' home in Kuopio), however, a fine ice fog display began outside, to which by midday were added, among other things, a more spectacular "grain-silo parhelion" than last year's (see T+A 3/86), as well as a subsun. Just as I get to this point in the sentence, the subsun shifts from sparkling about 50 meters away to 2-3 meters from my window and I must interrupt this writing to go buy more film. The date is actually January 11, so this halo display officially belongs to the next review.

FOR THE HALO REVIEW (UMi 2/87) OBSERVATIONS by MARCH 10. YEAR 1986 HALO OBSERVATIONS by FEBRUARY 10.



SIVUAURINKO

ATMOPHERIC OPTICAL PHENOMENA / Halos

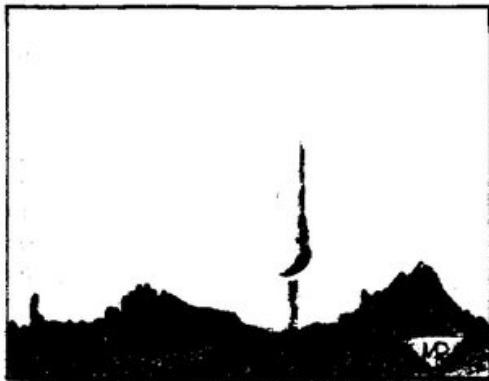
Edited by Marko Pekkola

THE SCARCE LATE YEAR HALOS

November and December passed entirely in traditional fashion, and this is reflected in the page count of this issue's SAur column as well. Determining the best halo months of the year is surprisingly difficult, as the annual (and observer-specific) variations are large. However, one thing seems to hold true from year to year: October, November, and December are definitely not among the best. October and November are probably the most dismal. December's halo count gets a slight boost from the occasional swirling of ice fog near the ground, but even that doesn't feel at all too abundant, since the best ice fog months are only in January and February.

NOVEMBER & WINDOW

There wouldn't have been anything to say about November originally without the latest territorial conquest by the Kuopio ice fog & special halo specialists. On the morning of November 14, observers Juhana Hakumäki and Timo Nousiainen noticed a colored 22° halo in the large windowpane of their school classroom (ice crystals floated/condensed on the window glass!) and made an observation of it. Seeing a corona in a frosty or dirty window isn't anything new – this phenomenon is mentioned, for example, by Minnaert – but seeing a halo in a window is already news, since at least the international halo literature I have collected doesn't know of such an apparition. The thing repeated on December 3, when Hakumäki, in similar conditions, saw not only the 22° halo (colors modestly from red to violet and as two consecutive spectra following each other), but also a smaller approximately 9° radius ring in the same windowpane (90° long at the center angle, colors: ROY, medium bright). This last one is starting to get a bit difficult to comment on. I'll settle for hoping for a photo of the window halo in general and especially of that smaller ring, assuming it appears again sometime. Thanks to Juhana and Timo, the "halo formation conditions table" that I painstakingly prepared for the last UMi column aged unusually quickly into the "incomplete" category. I leave a little apprehensively awaiting in what conditions (after grass and window halos) they'll next manage to see a halo.



ARRIVAL OF ICE FOG

The ice fog halos were unusually late this year. On the left is one of the first ones observed. Markku Ruonala's drawing of a moon pillar seen in Kemi on the night of 6-7 December. Note the unusual shift of the pillar from left to right. A faint upper tangent arc is left above the image.